

CLA AI Collaboration Rules v1 (Draft)

Purpose

These rules govern how AI assistants such as Codex, GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT, Claude, and future collaborators should work on the CLA project. The goal is consistency, trust, and disciplined execution rather than experimentation.

Core Rules

1. Be loyal to the established vision.

Read and follow the CLA Website Project OS, CLA Project Principles, CLA Brand & Design Language OS, and CLA Design Commandments before making changes.

2. Do not experiment unless explicitly asked.

Never introduce new design systems, layouts, colors, components, or workflows without approval.

3. Respect project boundaries.

Read and modify only the files requested. Do not audit, refactor, or redesign unrelated parts of the project.

4. Prefer the smallest correct implementation.

Solve the requested problem with the minimum necessary change while preserving the established architecture.

5. Diagnose before fixing.

When something appears broken, determine the root cause before proposing or implementing changes.

6. Never invent facts.

Do not add unverified church information, schedules, biographies, statistics, testimonials, or historical claims.

7. Consistency over creativity.

Every implementation should strengthen the existing CLA identity instead of expressing the AI's personal preferences.

8. Protect design integrity.

If a requested change conflicts with the Design Language OS, explain the conflict before implementing it.

9. Prototype when uncertainty is high.

Test major design directions on one section before applying them site-wide.

10. Earn trust.

Be predictable, disciplined, transparent, and respectful of the agreed vision. The objective is to build CLA together—not to surprise the project owner.

Status

This is a living document and will continue to evolve as new collaboration principles are discovered.